About the Author



Dr. Gieve Patel is one of the prominent Indian poets. His famous works include Evening, Forensic Medicine, and From Bombay Central. He has also penned three plays. He has been conducting a poetry workshop in Rishi Valley School for more than a decade. This poem is taken from his poetry collection 'Poems' published in 1966.

Glossary

jab (v) :
to poke, or thrust abruptly with a short, quick blow

crust (n) :
the brown, hard outer portion or surface

leprous (adj)
covered with scales

hide (n)
the strong thick outer skin

miniature (adj.) :
very small

A. *Memorize the first two stanzas of the poem.

B. Read the following lines from the poem and answer the questions in a sentence or two.

1. *It takes much time to kill a tree,*
   Not a simple jab of the knife
   Will do it.
   i. Can a 'simple jab of the knife' kill a tree?
   ii. Why does it take much time to kill a tree?

2. *It has grown*
   Slowly consuming the earth,
   Rising out of it, feeding
   Upon its crust, absorbing
   i. How has the tree grown?
   ii. What does the tree feed from the crust?

3. *And out of its leprous hide*
   Sprouting leaves.
   i. What does the phrase 'leprous hide' mean?
   ii. What comes out of the leprous hide?

4. *The bleeding bark will heal*
   And from close to the ground
   Will rise curled green twigs,
   Miniature boughs
   i. What will happen to the bleeding bark?
   ii. What will rise from close to the ground?

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